

COVER TO COVER THE FEAST OF FIRSTFRUITS

From Richard Booker's book: see teaching notes below:

((The third step in our walk with God is represented by the Feast of Firstfruits. As with the Feast of Unleavened Bread, it too relates to our condition as believers in and followers of Jesus. These feasts show the two different phases of Christian commitment that are necessary to change our spiritual condition. These two phases are separation and consecration. Whereas the Feast of Unleavened Bread teaches us about separation, the Feast of Firstfruits teaches us about consecration. HISTORICAL BACKGROUND God gives the following instructions concerning this feast:

"And the Lord spoke to Moses saying, 'Speak to the children of Israel, and say to them: "When you come into the land which I give to you, and reap its harvest, then you shall bring a sheaf of the firstfruits of your harvest to the priest. He shall wave the sheaf before the Lord, to be accepted on your behalf....And you shall offer on that day, when you wave the sheaf, a male lamb of the first year, without blemish, as a burnt offering to the Lord. Its grain offering shall be twotenths of an ephah of fine flour mixed with oil, an offering made by fire to the Lord, for a sweet aroma; and its drink offering shall be of wine, one-fourth of a hin. You shall eat neither bread nor parched grain nor fresh grain until the same day that you have brought an offering to your God; it shall be a statute forever throughout your generations in all your dwellings'" (Leviticus 23:9-14). We learn in verse 11 that the Feast of Firstfruits was to be celebrated on the day after the Sabbath. Jewish Jewish scholars have different opinions as to which Sabbath God intended, but it appears to have been the regular weekly Sabbath. This means that the Feast of Firstfruits was on the first day of the week, a Sunday. The Hebrews were to bring the first sheaves (omer) of the barley harvest and wave them before the Lord. An omer was about four pints, or two quarts, or a half gallon of barley. Before any barley produce of the new crop could be eaten, or even touched, a measure had to be brought to the temple as an offering to the Lord. This offering is known as the omer. The period of time between this feast and the Feast of Pentecost is a time of the "Counting of the Omer." The counting always started at day one and continued until day fifty, as follows: Today is the first day of the omer; today is the second day of the omer; today is the third day of the omer, etc. By its very nature, physical work in the fields can cause us to forget our spiritual nature. Therefore, God gave the farmer these instructions so that he would remain conscious of his true purpose in life, which was to love, serve, and obey God, depending on Him for everything. By offering the firstfruits of his harvest to the Lord, the farmer was acknowledging his total dependence on God. The Jewish people were to bring the first sheaves of the barley harvest and wave them before the Lord. A small plot of ground was set apart in the Kidron Valley to grow this firstfruits offering. According to Alfred Edersheim in his book, The Temple, the sheaves were cut late in the afternoon, just before sunset. When the time for the cutting of the sheaf had arrived, a large, loud crowd of worshipers followed representative leaders to the place where the Firstfruits were to be harvested. It was almost dark as they sang, played their instruments, danced, and celebrated the goodness of God. After the sheaf was cut, the people praised the Lord and retraced their path up the slopes of the Temple mount to the altar. It was now officially the

“morrow after the Sabbath.”¹ Edersheim explains, “The ears were brought into the Court of the Temple, and thrashed out with canes or stalks, so as not to injure the corn; then parched on a pan perforated with holes, so that each grain might be touched by the fire. The omer was mixed with three-fourths of a pint of oil, and a handful of frankincense put on it, then waved before the Lord, and a handful taken out and burned on the altar.”² The purpose of this special service was to consecrate the harvest to God. The firstfruits represented the whole harvest. This act reminded the Hebrews that God had given them the land and that all of the harvest rightfully belonged to Him. The people were just stewards of the land. Offering the firstfruits actually consecrated the entire harvest to God. If God accepted the firstfruits of the harvest, it meant the entire harvest would be accepted by God.

HOW JESUS FULFILLED THE FEAST Jesus fulfilled this feast when He was resurrected as the Firstfruits from the dead. His resurrection marked the beginning of the harvest of souls who have been set apart for God through Jesus. Paul spoke of Jesus as the fulfillment of this feast with these words, “But now Christ [Messiah] is risen from the dead, and has become the firstfruits of those who have fallen asleep. For since by man came death, by Man also came the resurrection of the dead. For in Adam all die, even so in Christ [Messiah] all shall be made alive. But each one in his own order: Christ [Messiah] the firstfruits, afterward those who are Christ’s [Messiah’s] at His coming” (1 Cor. 15:20-23). Jesus was that human sheaf that God set apart for the purpose of conquering death and providing eternal life for all who would acknowledge Him as Messiah, Lord, and Savior. As such, He was the first who would rise from the dead never to die again. Once again we refer to the chart titled When was Jesus Crucified and Resurrected? In fulfilling the Feast of Passover, Jesus was crucified on Wednesday, the 14th. To fulfill the Feast of Unleavened Bread, He was buried at the close of Wednesday and the beginning of Thursday, the 15th. He was resurrected at the close of the weekly Sabbath, the 17th and the beginning of the first day of the week, the Feast of Firstfruits, the 18th. Matthew gives the following account of Jesus’ resurrection: “Now after the Sabbath [at the end or close of the Sabbath], as the first day of the week began to dawn [just as it began to get dark], Mary Magdalene and the other Mary came to see the tomb. And behold, there was a great earthquake; for an angel of the Lord descended from heaven, and came and rolled back the stone from the door, and sat on it. His countenance was like lightning, and his clothing as white as snow. And the guards shook for fear of him, and became like dead men. But the angel answered and said to the women, ‘Do not be afraid, for I know that you seek Jesus, who was crucified. He is not here; for He is risen, as He said. Come, see the place where the Lord lay’” (Matt. 28:1-6). Let’s read Matthew 28:1 again in light of its cultural context: “Now late on Sabbath, as it was getting dusk toward the first day of the week, Mary the Magdalene and the other Mary came to see the sepulcher.” The proper understanding of this text indicates that the women came to the tomb late in the day or toward the end of the day. It does not mean after the day is over or completed. (See also John 20:1; Mark 16:9-11.) John added some further details and mentioned the following statement Jesus made to Mary: “Do not cling to Me [touch Me not], for I have not yet ascended to My Father; but go to My brethren, and say to them, ‘I am ascending to My Father and your Father, and to My God, and your God’” (John 20:17). It was during this feast celebration at the temple that Jesus was resurrected. He was resurrected in the evening (sunset, not sunrise) at the time the firstfruits offering was cut and waved before God. As the barley sheaf could not be touched until it was offered to God, so

Jesus, the human sheaf, could not be touched until He offered Himself in the heavenly temple as the firstfruits from the dead.

Jesus was going to ascend to the Father for the purpose of presenting Himself as the firstfruits from the dead. He is our great High Priest who offered Himself in fulfillment of the Feast of Firstfruits on the exact day the barley sheaves were being waved before the Lord. The barley sheaf wave offering consisted of a number of individual barley stalks that had been bundled together. Likewise, when Jesus offered Himself as the firstfruits from the dead, many individual believers were raised with Him. Matthew explained: "And the graves were opened; and many bodies of the saints who had fallen asleep were raised; and coming out of the graves after His resurrection, they went into the holy city and appeared to many" (Matthew 27:52-53). When the time came to harvest the crop, the farmer would go into his field and inspect the firstfruits of the crop. If he accepted the firstfruits, then the rest of the harvest would also be acceptable to him. Since our Heavenly Father has accepted Jesus as the firstfruits from the dead, believers are also acceptable to God through Jesus. He will also raise us from the dead and give us a new resurrected body fitted for eternity. Paul expressed this truth to the Christians in Rome with these words: "But if the Spirit of Him who raised Jesus from the dead dwells in you, He who raised Christ [Messiah] from the dead will also give life to your mortal bodies through His Spirit who dwells in you" (Romans 8:11). Jesus, as the firstfruits, is our representative. By presenting Himself, He consecrated the rest of us to the Father. As Paul so clearly and boldly said to the Christians in Ephesus: "He [God] made us accepted in the Beloved" (Eph. 1:6). Believers are the human stalks that have been bundled together with Christ [Messiah]; therefore, "If the firstfruit is holy, the lump is also holy; and if the root is holy, so are the branches" (Rom. 11:16). Paul writes to the Corinthian believers: "Behold, I tell you a mystery; We shall not all sleep, but we shall all be changed—in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trumpet. For the trumpet will sound, and the dead will be raised incorruptible, and we shall be changed. For this corruptible must put on incorruption, and this mortal must put on immortality. So when this corruptible has put on incorruption, and this mortal has put on immortality, then shall be brought to pass the saying that is written: 'Death is swallowed up in victory.' 'O Death, where is your sting? O Hades, where is your victory?' The sting of death is sin, and the strength of sin is the law. But thanks be to God, who gives us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ [Yeshua the Messiah]. Therefore, my beloved brethren, be steadfast, immovable, always abounding in the work of the Lord, knowing that your labor is not in vain in the Lord" (1 Corinthians 15:51-58).

In his letter to the Thessalonian believers, Paul speaks further on this theme: "But I do not want you to be ignorant, brethren, concerning those who have fallen asleep, lest you sorrow as others who have no hope. For if we believe that Jesus died and rose again, even so God will bring with Him those who sleep in Jesus. For this we say to you by the word of the Lord, that we who are alive and remain until the coming of the Lord will by no means precede those who are asleep. For the Lord Himself will descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of an archangel, and with the trumpet of God. And the dead in Christ [Messiah] will rise first. Then we who are alive and remain shall be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air. And thus we shall always be with the Lord" (1 Thessalonians 4:13-17). In an additional word of comfort, Paul wrote: "For God did not appoint us to

wrath, but to obtain salvation through our Lord Jesus Christ [Messiah], who died for us, that whether we wake or sleep, we should live together with Him. Therefore, comfort each other and edify one another, just as you also are doing” (1 Thessalonians 5:9-11). When Lazarus died, his sister came to Jesus for comfort. John recorded the following conversation: “Now Martha, as soon as she heard that Jesus was coming, went and met Him, but Mary was sitting in the house. Now Martha said to Jesus, ‘Lord, if You had been here, my brother would not have died. But even now I know that whatever you ask of God, God will give You.’ Jesus said to her, ‘Your brother will rise again.’ Martha said to Him, ‘I know that he will rise again in the resurrection at the last day.’ Jesus said to her, ‘I am the resurrection and the life. He who believes in Me, though he may die, he shall live.

And whoever lives and believes in Me shall never die. Do you believe this?’” (John 11:20-26). Job expressed this hope for believers of all ages when he said, “For I know that my Redeemer lives, and He shall stand at last on the earth; and after my skin is destroyed, this I know, that in my flesh I shall see God” (Job 19:25-26). Lord, may Your name be praised forever! May we know You at Passover, the fellowship of Your suffering at Unleavened Bread, and the power of Your resurrection at Firstfruits.

TEACHING NOTES STARTS HERE:

Spring Feasts: March or April

- 1. Passover: Jesus crucified**
- 2. Unleavened Bread: Jesus was buried**
- 3. Feast of First Fruits: Jesus Resurrected.**

50 days later:

- 4. The Feast of Weeks (Shavuot) or Pentecost: Jesus send the Holy Spirit.**

All these happened in History. The next three are already and not yet...

They are being fulfilled in us, and finding their fulfillment in the prophetic end of days.

5. Feasts of Trumpets

6. Day of Atonement

7. Feasts of Tabernacles (Sukkot)

At Passover, God dealt with my position. — I was guilty, but the blood justified me. Justification happened here.

At Unleavened Bread, God dealt with my condition — I was set apart and sanctified. Sanctification.

Nowlet's look at First fruits:

THE FEAST OF FIRST-FRUITS

From Separation to Consecration — From Death to Resurrection

OPENING (5 minutes) — SETTING THE FRAME

Class, today I don't just want to teach you something.
I want to **take you somewhere**.

Because God does not reveal truth just to inform us —
He reveals truth to **transform us**.

There are **steps** in our walk with God.
There are **phases** in our spiritual journey.
And God, in His mercy, marked those phases on His calendar.

The Feasts of the Lord are not Jewish traditions that expired —
they are **divine rehearsals** of God's redemptive plan.

They show us:

- How God saves
- How God cleanses

- And how God consecrates

And today, we are looking at the **Feast of Firstfruits**.

I. THREE FEASTS — ONE JOURNEY (5 minutes)

Let me remind you of the progression.

Passover

That's where the blood was applied.
That's where judgment passed over.
That's where salvation began.

Dealt with our POSITION....JUSTIFICATION

Unleavened Bread

That's where leaven was removed.
That's where sin was dealt with.
That's where separation took place.

Dealt with our CONDITION....SANCTIFICATION

But — **God never intended for separation to be the end.**

Because you can be separated and still not be surrendered.

That brings us to the **third step**.

Firstfruits

This feast is not about what God removes —
it's about what God **receives**.

Separation cleans the vessel.
Consecration fills the vessel.

And until something is consecrated, it is not fully God's.

II. GOD'S COMMAND: GIVE ME THE FIRST (6 minutes)

Listen to the Word of the Lord from Leviticus 23.

“When (not if) you come into the land which I give you, and reap its harvest, then you shall bring a sheaf of the firstfruits of your harvest to the priest...”

Notice the language.

God says:

- *The land I give you*
- *The harvest you reap*

But before you enjoy it...
Before you benefit from it...
Before you even touch it...

Bring Me the first.

Church, God has always claimed the first.

The firstborn.
The first tenth.
The first fruit.

Why?

Because **the first represents the whole.**

If God accepts the first —
the rest is already covered.

III. PAINTING THE SCENE OF FIRST-FRUITS (6 minutes)

Now let me take you there.

Just outside Jerusalem, in the **Kidron Valley**,
there was a small field set apart —
not for profit, not for people —
but **for God.**

As the sun began to set, the city stirred.

A crowd gathered.
Singers lifted their voices.
Musicians struck their strings.
Worship filled the air. They danced.

They celebrated.
They rejoiced in the goodness of God.

(((According to Alfred Edersheim in his book, The Temple, the sheaves were cut late in the afternoon, just before sunset. When the time for the cutting of the sheaf had arrived, a large, loud crowd of worshipers followed representative leaders to the place where the Firstfruits were to be harvested. It was almost dark as they sang, played their instruments, danced, and celebrated the goodness of God. After the sheaf was cut, the people praised the Lord and retraced their path up the slopes of the Temple mount to the altar. It was now officially the “morrow after the Sabbath.”¹ Edersheim explains, “The ears were brought into the Court of the Temple, and thrashed out with canes or stalks, so as not to injure the corn; then parched on a pan perforated with holes, so that each grain might be touched by the fire. The omer was mixed with three-fourths of a pint of oil, and a handful of frankincense put on it, then waved before the Lord, and a handful taken out and burned on the altar.”² The purpose of this special service was to consecrate the harvest to God. The firstfruits represented the whole harvest.)))

And just before sunset —
as the day was ending and a new one was beginning —
the sheaf was cut.

Ordinary barley.
But the moment it was lifted —
it became **holy**.

Not because it was special,
but because it was **offered**.

IV. WHY GOD REQUIRED FIRST FRUITS⁵ minutes)

God knew something about us.

Work can distract us.
Provision can deceive us.
Blessing can make us forget.

THE MODERN FIELDS WE WORK IN

By its very nature, **physical work** pulls our attention downward.

In Bible times, it was literal fields —
dirt under fingernails, sun on the back, harvest schedules, survival pressure.

Today, the fields look different —
but the effect is the same.

Our fields are:

- Careers and deadlines
- Businesses and bottom lines
- Emails, notifications, and algorithms
- Parenting schedules, bills, and responsibilities
- Hustle culture, side gigs, and survival mode

And here's the truth we don't like to admit:

□ **Productivity has a way of numbing spirituality.**

Not because work is bad —
but because work is consuming.

WHEN WORK BECOMES ALL-CONSUMING

The danger was never the field.

The danger was **forgetting why you're in the field.**

A farmer could spend months focused on:

- Weather
- Soil
- Pests
- Yield

And slowly forget:

- Who gave the land
- Who sends the rain
- Who causes the increase

In the same way, today we can become:

- Highly productive
- Financially responsible
- Relentlessly busy

...and spiritually **unaware.**

We don't lose our faith overnight.
We lose it **gradually** — by distraction.

GOD'S INTERRUPTIVE GRACE

So God did something intentional.

He **interrupted productivity** with worship.

He told the farmer:

“Before you eat it...
Before you sell it...
Before you benefit from it...
Bring the first to Me.”

Why?

Because God knew:

- Work trains your hands
- But worship trains your heart

Firstfruits forced the farmer to stop long enough to remember:

□ *“I am more than what I produce.”*

So God said:

“Bring Me the first — so you remember.”

Firstfruits declared:

- God is the source
- God is the owner
- We are stewards, not masters

Church, Firstfruits was a **heart posture**.

It said:

“Everything I have comes from You,
and everything I have belongs to You.”

That’s consecration.

V. JESUS: THE TRUE FIRST FRUITS (6 minutes)

Now here’s where heaven interrupts history.

Jesus resurrection marked the beginning of the harvest of souls/sons.

1 Cor 15:20-23

Jesus did not just rise —
He rose **on purpose,**
on time,
on the feast.

The Feast of Firstfruits was always pointing to **Him**.

Just as the barley sheaf was lifted before God...
Jesus, the **human sheaf**, was lifted from the grave.

The first to rise — never to die again.

And because the Father accepted **Him** —
the harvest of souls is guaranteed.

VI. THE TIMING OF THE RESURRECTION (5 minutes)

This will change how you read the resurrection story.

Jesus was not resurrected at sunrise.
He was resurrected at **sunset**.

Matthew tells us:

“Now late on the Sabbath, as it was getting dusk toward the first day of the week...”

At the very moment the priest was waving the barley sheaf in the Temple...
Heaven was waving the Son.

And when Mary tried to touch Him, Jesus said:

“Do not cling to Me, for I have not yet ascended to My Father.”

Why?

Because the Firstfruits **cannot be touched**
until it is presented to God.

Jesus had to ascend —
to present Himself
as the Firstfruits from the dead.

VII. WE WERE BUNDLED WITH HIM (5 minutes)

Now don't miss this.

The Firstfruits offering was not one stalk —
it was **many stalks bound together**.

Matthew tells us:

“And many bodies of the saints were raised...”

When Jesus rose, **He wasn't alone**.

□ When He was lifted — we were lifted.

□ When He was accepted — we were accepted.

Paul said:

“He made us accepted in the Beloved.”

Class, you are not fighting for acceptance —
you are living **from acceptance**.

VIII. THE PROMISE OF OUR RESURRECTION (5 minutes)

Because the Firstfruits was accepted...look what happened....

BARLEY, “BAR,” AND THE HARVEST OF SONS

In Hebrew, the word for barley is **שְׂעוֹרָה** (se'orah...also the word for grain), but embedded in the language and in rabbinic imagery is the word “**BAR**.”

Bar is the word for grain.

(((The Hebrew word, bar, or “grain,” may possibly be the root of our modern word for barley. But bar also has some other meanings. It means a SON, in the sense of an heir. For example, Barabbas ([John 18:40](#)) means “son of the father,” and Barnabas means “son of consolation” ([Acts 4:36](#)). Barley thus signifies the overcomers, who are known also as the “sons of God.” This term is used of Israel in [Hosea 1:10](#), because the prophet pictures Israel as being seed scattered in the field (the world), who ultimately would bring forth a great harvest of sons. In [John 1:12](#) But as many as received Him (Jesus), to them He gave the right to become the children of God, even to those who believe in His name.

Roman 8:14 For all who are being led by the Spirit of God, these are the sons of God. . . 16 The Spirit Himself bears witness with our spirit that we are the children of God, 17 and if children, heirs also, heirs of God and fellow heirs with Christ . . . 19 For the anxious longing of the creation waits eagerly for the revealing of the sons of God.)))

BAR means **son**.

It's the same word you hear in:

- **Bar-Mitzvah** — “son of the commandment”
- **Bar-Jonah** — “son of Jonah”
- **Bar-Abba** — “son of the father”

And that matters — because **Firstfruits was a barley harvest**.

God didn't choose barley by accident.
He chose barley because it prophetically pointed to **sons**.

FIRSTFRUITS WAS NEVER JUST ABOUT GRAIN

“The Feast of Firstfruits was not a harvest of crops —
it was a **harvest of sons**.”

Barley was the **first crop to ripen** in Israel.
It came up early.
It came up strong.
It survived harsh conditions.

Just like sons who mature through pressure.

JESUS: THE FIRST SON HARVESTED

Jesus is called:

- The **only begotten Son** John 3:16
- The **firstborn among many brethren** Romans 8:29
- The **heir of all things** Hebrews 1:12

When Jesus rose from the dead, He was:
The first BAR lifted to the Father.

Paul confirms it:

“That He might be the firstborn among many brethren.” (Romans 8:29)

Firstfruits wasn't about Jesus being the **only** Son —
it was about Jesus being the **first** Son.

The first Son presented
So many sons could follow

FROM SERVANTS TO SONS

Let's make it personal.

Slaves work for survival.
Servants work for approval.
But **sons work from inheritance.**

Firstfruits declared:

“This harvest belongs to the Father —
and the sons belong in the house.”

Paul says:

“You did not receive the spirit of bondage again to fear, but you received the Spirit of adoption by whom we cry out, ‘Abba, Father.’” (Romans 8:15)

The barley harvest wasn't just lifted —
it was **claimed.**

HEIRS, NOT HIRED HANDS

“Firstfruits reminds us that we are not God's employees —
we are God's heirs.”

Heirs don't beg.
Heirs don't earn.
Heirs receive what belongs to the family.

And because Jesus, the **First Son**, was accepted —
every son bundled with Him is accepted too.

THE BUNDLED BARLEY = A FAMILY OF SONS

Remember:
The barley sheaf wasn't one stalk.

It was **many stalks bound together**.

Jesus rose —
and many rose with Him.

□ One Son lifted
□ Many sons included

This is why Scripture says:

“If the firstfruit is holy, the lump is also holy.”

You were in the bundle.

FIRST FRUITS AND IDENTITY IN TODAY'S WORLD

This brings us right back to modern life.

Our culture trains people to live like:

- Workers
- Performers
- Producers
- Survivors

But Firstfruits declares:

“You are not defined by your output —
you are defined by your sonship.”

Barley had to be **offered before it could be eaten**.

Likewise:
□ Identity comes before productivity.

You don't work **to become** a son.
You work **because you are** a son.

A STRONG DECLARATION TO CLOSE

“The first harvest God celebrated was barley — because the first thing God wanted back was **sons**.”

“Firstfruits is the Father counting His children — and saying, ‘They’re Mine.’”

THE BIG IDEA

The Feast of Firstfruits was the prophetic moment when God declared that resurrection would not just produce life — it would produce sons and heirs.

READ

Colossians 3:1-4

Col 2:12-13

1COR 15:21

ROMANS 5:12-21

ROMANS 6:5-6

THE THREE FEASTS AND THE THREE DIMENSIONS OF SALVATION

You can say it simply and powerfully:

Passover deals with our position .

Unleavened Bread deals with our conditions.

Firstfruits deals with our identity and destiny.

Or in theological language:

- **Passover — Justification** (what was done *for* us)
- **Unleavened Bread — Sanctification** (what is done *in* us)
- **Firstfruits — Glorification / Sonship** (what is declared *over* us)

PASSOVER: OUR CONDITION — JUSTIFICATION

Passover answers this question:

“What condition am I in before God?”

We were:

- Guilty
- Bound
- Condemned
- Under judgment

But the blood was applied.

Passover didn't change our behavior —
it changed our **standing**.

- ☐ We were justified.
- ☐ Declared righteous.
- ☐ Saved from judgment.

UNLEAVENED BREAD: OUR CONDITION — SANCTIFICATION

Unleavened Bread answers a different question:

“Where do I now stand?”

God says:

“Come out. Be separate. Remove the leaven.”

This is sanctification.

Not perfection —
but **conditioning** .

Set apart
Consecrated from sin
Conditioned in holiness

We are no longer in Egypt —
and Egypt is no longer meant to be in us.

FIRSTFRUITS: OUR IDENTITY & DESTINY — SONSHIP AND GLORY

Now Firstfruits answers the deepest question of all:

“Who am I now... and what am I becoming?”

Firstfruits is not about cleansing —
it’s about **claiming**.

Not about rescue —
but about **relationship**.

Firstfruits declares: “*You are not just forgiven servants — you are resurrected sons.*”

Jesus didn’t rise just to prove He was alive.
He rose to **define who we are**.

Paul says:

“He is the firstborn among many brethren.”

That’s identity language.
That’s family language.
That’s inheritance language.

FIRSTFRUITS AND GLORIFICATION

Theologically, Firstfruits points to **glorification**.

Not just one day in the future —
but a **present declaration** with future fulfillment.

Because Jesus, the Firstfruits, was accepted:

- Our resurrection is guaranteed
- Our inheritance is secured
- Our destiny is sealed

We are heirs now, even if the fullness comes later.

HOW THIS PREACHES (PUT IT TOGETHER)

Here’s a strong, preach-ready paragraph you can lift directly:

“At Passover, God dealt with my position — I was guilty, but the blood justified me.
At Unleavened Bread, God dealt with my condition — I was set apart and sanctified.

But at Firstfruits, God dealt with my identity — I am no longer just saved from death, I am raised as a son with an inheritance.”

THE PROGRESSION IN ONE LINE

You could also say it this way:

“Passover saves me.
Unleavened Bread shapes me.
Firstfruits names me.”

WHY THIS MATTERS TODAY

Because many believers:

- Live justified but insecure
- Sanctified but still orphan-minded
- Clean but unsure who they are

Firstfruits answers that orphan spirit.

It says:

“You belong.
You are accepted.
You are an heir.”

A POWERFUL CLOSING DECLARATION

You could close the section like this:

“Passover got me out of Egypt.
Unleavened Bread got Egypt out of me.
But Firstfruits tells me why I was saved in the first place —
to be raised as a son in the house of the Father.”

(((Xtra notes)))

Death lost its grip.
The grave lost its authority.
The future was settled.

Paul declares:

“This mortal must put on immortality...”

And then he shouts:

“O Death, where is your sting?
O Grave, where is your victory?”

Church, resurrection is not a theory —
it’s a **promise**.

IX. COMFORT FOR TODAY, HOPE FOR ETERNITY (4 minutes)

Paul tells the Thessalonians:

“We do not grieve as those who have no hope.”

Why?

Because Firstfruits tells us:

- The dead will rise
- The trumpet will sound
- The Lord will descend
- And we will be with Him forever

This is why we can stand at gravesides with tears —
and still say **He lives**.

X. JESUS’ QUESTION STILL STANDS (3 minutes)

Standing before Martha, Jesus said:

“I am the resurrection and the life... Do you believe this?”

That is the question of Firstfruits.

Not:

- Do you understand it?
- Do you explain it?

But:

☐ **Do you believe it?**

Because if He lives —
you will live also.

CLOSING ALTAR MOMENT (FINAL 5 minutes)

Lord, today we stand at Firstfruits.

We thank You:

- For the blood of Passover
- For the cleansing of Unleavened Bread
- And for the power of resurrection life

We declare:

☐ Jesus is alive

☐ Death is defeated

☐ And the harvest belongs to God

May we not just be saved.

May we not just be separated.

But may we be **fully consecrated**.

Because the Firstfruits has been accepted —
the harvest is secure.

Amen. ☐

